USER GUIDE

Christmas Gift Tracker

Plan the people, the gifts, and the budget without losing the thread.

Edition Offline, account-free **Version** 1.0.0 **Guide updated** 31 October 2026

This guide explains every screen in the offline edition, how the totals are calculated, how to protect your data, and what the app deliberately does not do. It is written for the tested build. If the app and this guide ever disagree, the app's on-screen explanations and the current release notes take priority.

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1. About this edition

Christmas Gift Tracker is a single-user Christmas gift planner. It keeps one season active at a time, with older seasons kept as read-only archives. Recipients, gifts, ideas, budgets, and notes live in this browser's local database.

Included in this edition	Not included
Seasons and archives; recipients; gifts and statuses; budgets and dashboard; budget-vs- actual chart; Idea Bank; Shopping List; search and filters; JSON backups; CSV export; sample data; themes; currency display; print views; offline app installation.	Accounts, sign-in, cloud sync, automatic/cloud backups, built-in PDF export, merging two backups, and verified Firefox/Safari/iOS behavior.

No account, no telemetry

The offline edition makes no network requests during core use. It has no account system, no analytics, no advertising, and no third-party runtime assets. The only network activity needed is the initial visit (and later app updates).

2. First run and installation

2.1 The one-time online visit

1. Open the app address supplied with your purchase in a current browser.
2. Let the page finish loading. The footer shows **"Saved on this device"** when online.
3. A banner may say **"Ready to work offline."** It means the app has cached its files. Choose **Got it**.

After this visit, the app can launch from its icon, home screen, or bookmark without a connection. Do not open `index.html` directly from a downloaded folder: browser storage and offline caching require a hosted `https://` address.

2.2 Install (optional but recommended)

Device and browser	How to install
Chrome or Edge on a computer	Use the install icon in the address bar, or browser menu > *Install this site as an app*.
Android	Browser menu > *Install app* or *Add to Home screen*.
iPhone or iPad (Safari)	Share > *Add to Home Screen*.
Firefox on a computer	No app install is offered. Bookmark the page; offline use still works after the first visit.

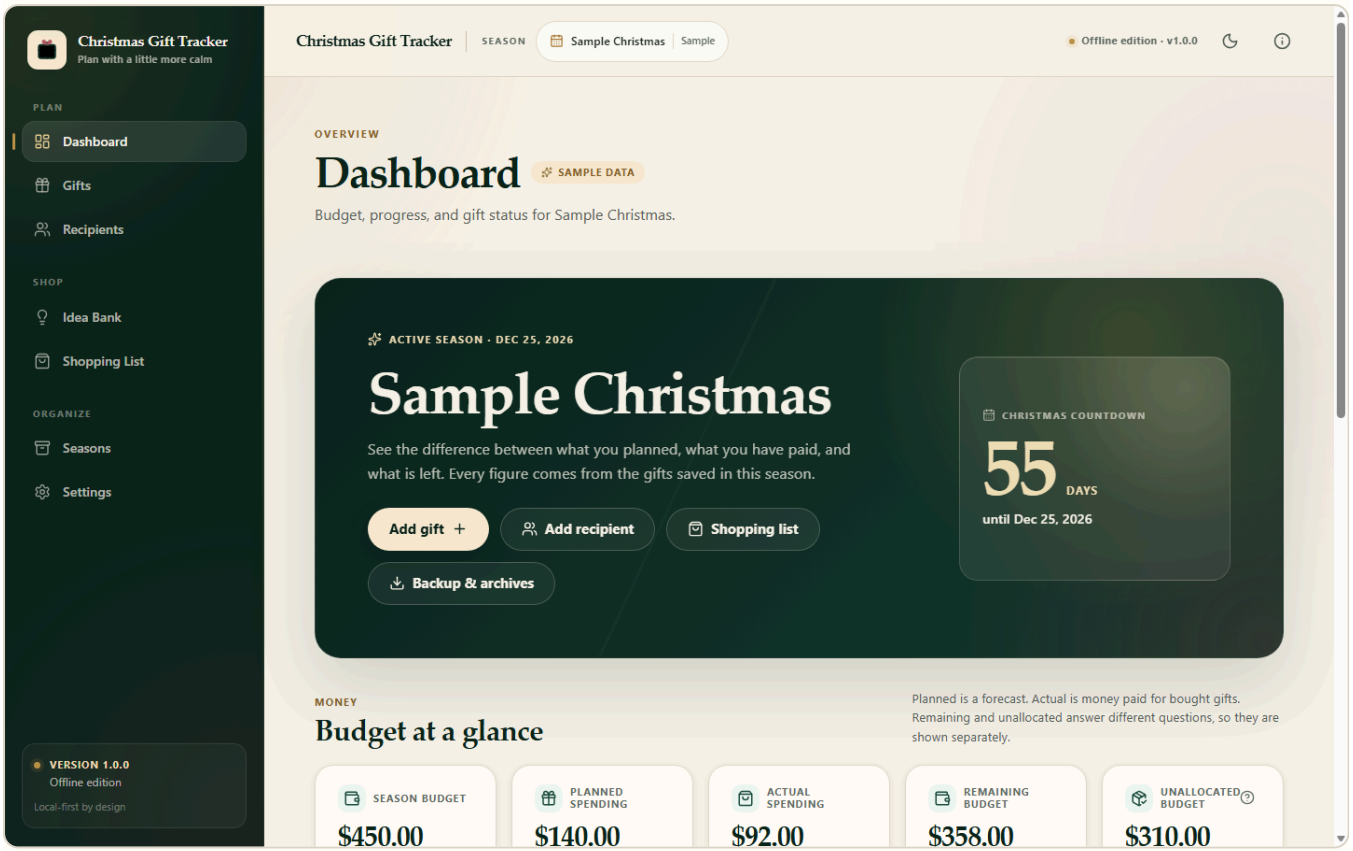
Installation behavior differs by browser and version. Microsoft Edge 156 on Windows is the configuration verified for this release. Chrome is expected to behave the same way. Safari, Firefox, Android, and iOS installation flows are documented guidance, not verified behavior.

2.3 Create the first season

The setup form asks for a season name, a Christmas date, and an optional season budget. You can also choose a light/dark/system theme and a currency. Nothing is saved until you submit the form.

If you want to explore first, tick **"Load the optional sample season."** The sample is flagged with a **SAMPLE DATA** badge. It can be removed later from **Seasons & archives** without affecting real records.

3. Dashboard



The dashboard uses only saved records; totals are recalculated, never stored twice.

The dashboard shows the active season (or an archived season, read-only). Each figure answers a different question:

Figure	Meaning
Season budget	The overall amount you set for the season. It can be left blank.
Planned spending	The sum of planned budgets across all gifts, whether bought or not.
Actual spending	The sum of actual costs for gifts marked bought. Unbought gifts contribute nothing.
Remaining budget	Season budget minus actual spending.
Unallocated budget	Season budget minus planned spending. It is not the same as remaining budget.

The countdown uses the season's Christmas date. The chart compares planned and actual amounts and includes an accessible table of the same numbers. Gift progress counts bought, wrapped, and sent gifts. Data-quality alerts point out gaps such as a bought gift with no actual cost.

Why two “budget left” numbers?

Remaining reflects money you have already spent. **Unallocated** reflects money not yet assigned to a gift plan. A season can have unallocated money and still be over its actual budget, or the reverse.

4. Seasons and archives

Open **Seasons & archives** from the sidebar. There is at most one active season. Starting a new season archives the current one in the same step; records are never merged between seasons.

4.1 Active season

- **Open dashboard** returns to the active season's overview.
- **Edit details** changes the name, date, or budget.
- **Archive season** makes the season read-only and leaves the app with no active season until you create or restore one.

4.2 Archived seasons

Archived seasons are read-only: you can view, export, print, and include them in backups, but not edit them. Restoring an archived season makes it active and archives the current active season in the same transaction.

4.3 New season and recipient copying

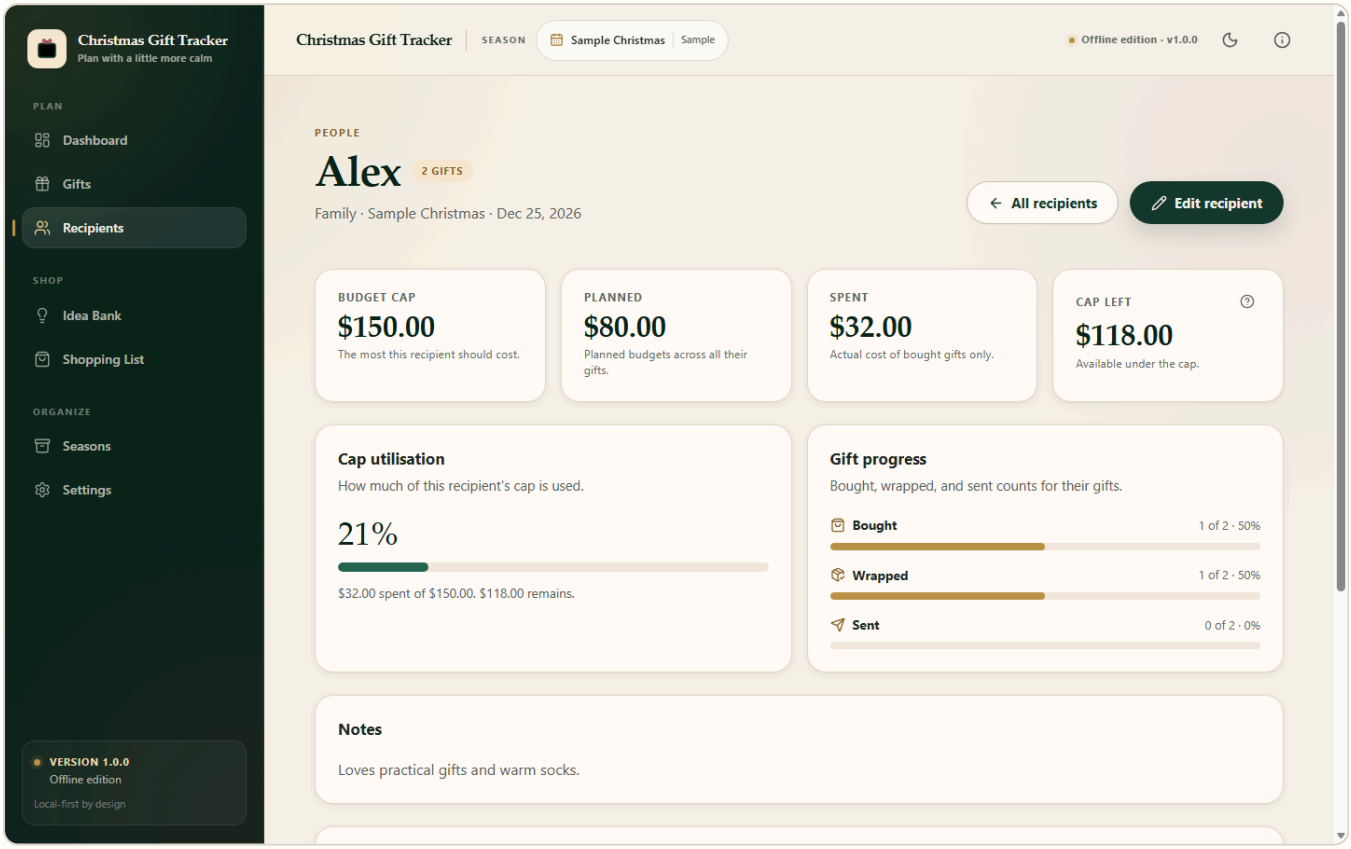
Creating a new season archives the current one. You can copy recipients from the previous season; their names, relationships, caps, and notes carry over, but gifts and ideas do not.

4.4 Delete an archived season

Deleting an archived season requires typing its exact name. The active season cannot be deleted this way. Sample seasons follow the sample-data rules described in section 10.

5. Recipients

Each recipient belongs to one season. A recipient can have a relationship, an optional spending cap, and notes. The recipients list shows planned and spent totals, while the detail page shows cap utilisation and gift progress.

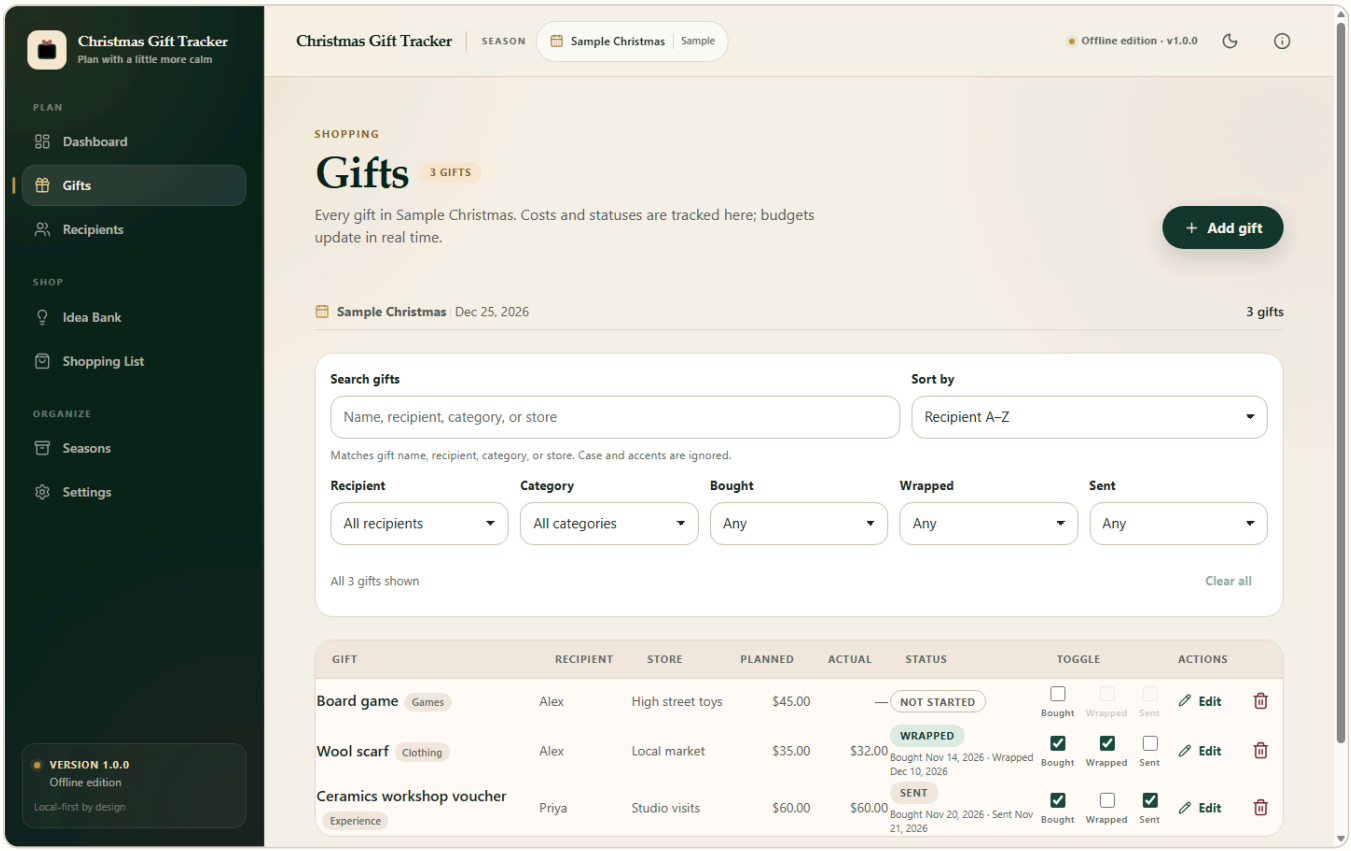


A recipient detail page with cap left and progress for that person only.

- **Budget cap** is the most this recipient should cost. It is a planning limit, not an enforced block.
- **Planned** sums planned budgets for that recipient's gifts.
- **Spent** sums actual costs for that recipient's bought gifts.
- **Cap left** is the cap minus spent. It can become negative and is labelled clearly.

Deleting a recipient who has gifts requires choosing what happens to those gifts: reassign them to another recipient (typing the source recipient's name to confirm) or delete them with the recipient. Ideas linked to the recipient become unassigned.

6. Gifts and statuses



Gifts are scoped to the active season, with search, filters, and quick status toggles.

A gift can include:

Required	Name and recipient.
Optional	Planned budget, actual cost, category, store, purchase link, delivery method, address, notes, and dates for bought, wrapped, and sent.

6.1 Status rules

- **Bought** records that you paid for the gift.
- **Wrapped** and **Sent** require Bought. Their controls are disabled until Bought is ticked.
- Wrapped and Sent are independent of each other; a gift can be sent without being marked wrapped.
- Un-buying a gift clears its wrapped and sent states. The app asks for confirmation before doing so.

6.2 Actual cost

Actual cost is optional. A bought gift with no actual cost appears in data-quality alerts so you can fill it in. Until then, spending uses only costs that exist.

6.3 Purchase links

Purchase links must start with http:// or https://. Other schemes are rejected. Opening a link offline may show the browser's no-connection page; the planner stays open.

6.4 Deleting a gift

Deleting a gift asks for confirmation. If the gift came from an idea, deleting it reopens that idea in the Idea Bank instead of losing it.

7. Idea Bank

The Idea Bank holds possibilities that are not yet gifts. Ideas do not count toward budgets, progress, or the Shopping List until you convert one.

- An idea can be assigned to a recipient or left unassigned.
- **Convert to gift** creates a gift and keeps the idea for reference. Conversion is duplicate-safe; clicking twice does not create a second gift.
- If the converted gift is deleted, the idea reopens.
- Search matches idea name, recipient, category, and store.

8. Shopping List

The Shopping List is generated from unbought gifts in the active season. It is never stored separately. Items are grouped by store, with a subtotal for each group and a total planned amount for the list.

- **Mark bought** uses the same status rules as the Gifts page and removes the item from the list.
- Marking an item bought does not invent an actual cost; add that on the gift when you know it.
- **Print list** gives a clean print view with the season and date, without navigation or controls.
- Archived seasons show no mark-bought controls.

9. Search, filters, and sorting

Gift search matches name, recipient, category, and store, ignoring case and common accent differences. You can combine search with recipient, category, bought, wrapped, and sent filters; all active conditions must match. Sorting covers name, planned budget, actual cost, and status.

The Idea Bank has its own search. Use **Clear all** or **Clear search** to reset the controls. Empty states explain how to remove filters when nothing matches.

10. Backups, restore, CSV, and resets

> **Your only portable copy is a backup file**
>
> The planner lives in this browser. Downloading a JSON backup is the deliberate way to keep a copy you can move, archive, or restore. There is no automatic or cloud backup in this edition.

10.1 Download a backup

Go to **Seasons & archives > Backup and restore > Download backup**. The JSON file includes settings, every season (active and archived), recipients, gifts, ideas, addresses, and notes. Keep it private.

10.2 Restore a backup

1. Choose the JSON file. The app validates it before writing anything.
2. Review the summary: exported date, season counts, record counts, and app version.
3. Download the current data. Restore stays disabled until you do.
4. Type **RESTORE** exactly, then choose **Restore backup (replace all data)**.

Restore **replaces** everything on this device. It does not merge two backups. Invalid, newer, or inconsistent files are rejected without changing current data.

10.3 CSV export

CSV export covers the active season or all seasons. Address and notes columns are off by default. Exported text that looks like a spreadsheet formula is neutralized with a leading apostrophe. The file is UTF-8 with a byte-order mark for Excel, Numbers, and Sheets.

10.4 Sample data

Sample data is optional and clearly flagged. You can load one sample season, explore it, and remove it later without touching real records. Sample seasons are read-only examples. Removing sample data is permanent, and an archived sample season cannot be restored; real seasons can. The included `Sample-Backup.json` also restores as flagged sample data.

10.5 Reset the planner

Reset erases this browser's planner data. It requires a fresh backup and typing **DELETE**. After a reset, the app returns to first-season setup. Reset is intentionally harder than deleting one record.

11. Appearance and currency

11.1 Themes

Choose Light, Dark, or System in **Settings > Appearance** or from the header toggle. The theme is applied before the page paints, so there is no flash. The choice is saved in this browser.

11.2 Currency display

Currency is **display-only**. Changing the code, symbol, or fraction digits reformats stored amounts; it never converts or rewrites them. If monetary data exists, the app asks for confirmation before reinterpreting the display.

11.3 How typed amounts are read

The amount field accepts an optional symbol, spaces, apostrophes, and grouping separators. A dot or comma is read as a decimal separator only when it is followed by at most the configured number of fraction digits. Otherwise it is treated as a grouping separator.

You type (USD, 2 fraction digits)	Stored as
12.50	$12.50
12,50	$12.50
12.345	$12,345.00 - three trailing digits are read as grouping
1,234.56	$1,234.56

Check the money preview before saving. If a separator is ambiguous for the currency you chose, type the amount without grouping separators.

12. Offline use, updates, and storage

12.1 Offline status

The footer reports the connection honestly: **“Saved on this device”** when online, and **“Offline”** (all data saved on this device) when offline. Offline mode does not block editing; the local database already works without a network.

12.2 Updates

When a new version is saved, a banner says **“A new version is ready.”** Choose **Reload to update** when convenient, or **Later** to dismiss it. If a dialog or form is open, the reload is refused with a reminder to close it first, so unsaved work is not discarded.

12.3 Persistent storage

Settings > Storage health can ask the browser for persistent storage. The app reports whether the request was granted, declined, or unsupported. A grant reduces the chance of eviction under disk pressure; it is not a guarantee. Keep backups.

12.4 Diagnostics

The same section shows counts and integrity issues only - no names, addresses, or notes. It also shows app and schema versions.

13. Privacy

- The offline edition stores planner data in this browser's IndexedDB on this device.
- There is no account, sign-in, cloud sync, analytics, telemetry, advertising, or third-party runtime asset.
- Backups and CSV exports are created on this device. They can contain sensitive addresses and notes; protect and delete them according to your own needs.
- The publisher's hosting provider may record standard technical request logs when you load or update the app, as any website host does.
- Purchase and order details are handled by Etsy, not by the app.
- Clearing site data deletes the planner. No app code path clears records automatically.

14. Keyboard and accessibility

- All primary actions are reachable by keyboard, with a visible focus ring.
- Dialogs move focus inside, close with Escape, and return focus to the trigger.
- Charts have a table alternative, and metric explanations are available by keyboard.
- Reduced-motion preferences are respected.
- Targets are sized for touch, and the layout adapts to narrow screens.
- Form errors are announced and linked to their fields.

15. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
The app does not open offline.	Visit the hosted address once more while online, wait for loading to finish, then try again. Private/incognito windows are not reliable for offline use.
A storage or quota message appears.	Your data has not been deleted. Download a backup first, free browser or disk space, and reload. Follow the steps in the message.
My data is missing after changing browsers or devices.	Data is per browser profile. Open the original browser, or restore a JSON backup from **Seasons & archives**.
The install option is missing.	Some browsers do not offer installation. Bookmark the app; offline use still works after one online visit.
An amount looks larger than I typed.	A single separator followed by more than the fraction digits is read as grouping. See section 11.3 and check the preview before saving.
I cannot restore an archived sample season.	Sample seasons are read-only examples and are not restorable. Real archived seasons can be restored.
Restore is disabled.	Download the current data first, then type **RESTORE** exactly. Both are required.
A purchase link does not open offline.	External links need a connection. The planner stays open; try the link later.

16. Known limitations

- **Offline setup is required.** One online visit is needed before the first offline launch; installation is per browser.
- **Local data can be cleared.** Clearing site data or resetting the browser profile deletes the planner. Backups are the recovery copy.
- **No cloud sync in this edition.** Data does not move between devices unless you export and restore a backup.
- **Restore is replace-all.** Merging two backups is not supported.
- **Backups are manual.** There is no automatic, scheduled, or cloud backup.
- **Currency does not convert.** It only changes how amounts are displayed.
- **Amount separators can be ambiguous.** A single separator with too many trailing digits is grouping; check the preview.
- **Printing uses the browser dialog.** There is no built-in PDF export.
- **Wrapped progress uses every gift as its denominator.** For digital or retailer-direct gifts that never need wrapping, 100% may not be reachable. Progress is informational.

- **Sample seasons are examples.** Removing sample data is permanent, and an archived sample season cannot be restored.
- **Browser verification is partial.** Offline behavior was verified in Microsoft Edge 156 on Windows. Firefox, Safari, iOS/iPadOS, and Android are documented guidance, not verified here.
- **No standalone HTML edition.** The app is not shipped as a single file opened from disk.
- **Large lists render in one page.** The interface remains usable with the tested large dataset, but very large seasons may scroll a long way; filters and search are the intended tools.
